

Northwind Retail Group — Employee Handbook (Fictional)

Welcome to Northwind

This handbook is a fictional sample document generated for testing purposes. It describes company policies for Northwind Retail Group, an imaginary company. Nothing in this document reflects a real organization.

First Week Checklist

New employees should complete the following during their first week:

- Complete new-hire paperwork in the HR portal by end of Day 1
- Meet with your assigned onboarding buddy
- Set up direct deposit and tax withholding forms
- Review the Code of Conduct and sign the acknowledgment form
- Attend the New Hire Orientation session on Thursday at 10:00 AM
- Schedule a 30-minute check-in with your manager for Friday

Working Hours & Attendance

Standard working hours are 9:00 AM to 5:30 PM, Monday through Friday, with a 30-minute unpaid lunch break. Employees may request flexible scheduling through their manager after the first 90 days of employment.

Leave Policy

Full-time employees accrue 15 days of paid time off (PTO) per year, plus 10 company holidays. PTO requests should be submitted at least two weeks in advance through the HR system.

- 15 PTO days per year (accrued monthly)
- 10 paid company holidays
- 5 paid sick days, separate from PTO
- 12 weeks of parental leave for eligible employees

Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to act with integrity, respect colleagues, and avoid conflicts of interest. Violations should be reported to HR or through the anonymous ethics hotline.

Performance Reviews

Performance reviews occur twice a year, in June and December. New employees receive an informal 30-day check-in and a formal 90-day review.